

Software Modernization Strategies



Ignore It!

Leave your system alone as long as it does its job well.



Keep It Alive!

Keep your legacy system running, but make it a conscious choice, not a habit.



Delegate!

Hand off what is holding you back and focus on what actually matters.



Give It Away!

Open-source what you can no longer advance alone, and let the community share the load.



Sell It!

Sell your legacy system to someone for whom it is worth more than it is to you.



Buy New!

Buy a ready-made solution when someone else has already solved your problem.



Shut It Down!

End your legacy system's operation in a planned, orderly, and drama-free way.



Consolidate It!

Replace your zoo of systems with fewer, more manageable units.



Standardize It!

Define how your systems are built, connected, and operated, and end the chaos.



Harmonize It!

Align your systems, models, and processes so they work together without friction.



Partner It!

Work with external partners to evolve your system together.



Bring It Back!

Take back control of your system when outsourcing costs more than it delivers.



Rethink It!

Do not question your system, question the assumptions it was built on.



Remodel It!

Align your system's structure with the domain as you understand it today.



Trim it down!

Remove what nobody needs anymore and give your system its actual purpose back.



Improve It!

Keep your system fit through continuous, unspectacular work before the debt catches up with you.



Convert it!

Keep your system's proven logic and only swap out the technology it lives in.



Fork It!

Split off part of your system and turn it into a standalone, independent solution.



Repurpose It!

Deploy your system for a new audience instead of maintaining it for a shrinking market.



Salvage It!

Keep the valuable components of your legacy system and leave the rest behind.



Wrap it!

Leave the core untouched and only modernize how your system talks to the outside world.



Replace it!

Build new when the old system is more burden than value.



Divide It!

Cut your system along its natural boundaries so one change no longer puts the whole system at risk.



Extract!

Pull the knowledge out of your system before you take the next step.



Preserve it!

Preserve your system so you can still start it when needed, without actively maintaining it.



Replatform it!

Give your system a new foundation when the code is still good but what is underneath no longer is.



Rehost it!

Move your system to a new environment and leave everything else as it is.



Upgrade Tools!

Bring your tooling up to date so legacy work becomes more efficient.



Align Strategy!

Align your organization's strategic direction toward a realistic approach to legacy.



Reshape Org!

Reshape teams, responsibilities, and incentives so legacy work finally works well.



Upskill People!

Invest in the people you already have before investing in new technology.



Improve Processes!

Improve not the system, but the way your team works with it.

Strategy Categories: Business (14) Development (10) Infrastructure (3) Enablement (5)

